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Misunderstanding cleared up: Skittles not banned in California

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Recently, a bill was passed in California that caused many residents to wonder if the popular Skittles candies would be banned in the state. The bill seeks to change some ingredients found in America's most popular candies and snacks.

Why were Skittles thought to be banned in California? Jesse Gabriel, a Democratic assembly member from Woodland Hills, California, introduced the legislation, called Assembly Bill (AB) 418, which would ban the sale of processed foods in California that contain certain chemicals he considers dangerous and toxic.

This quickly became known as the "Skittles ban," which now turned out to be a misnomer.

Gabriel explained that his intention is not to ban Skittles, but to make American candy less "dangerous" to eat.

He stated that he simply wants companies to make minor modifications to their recipes so that these products do not include dangerous and toxic chemicals.

Ingredients under scrutiny Four specific ingredients are under the spotlight: brominated vegetable oil, potassium bromate, propylparaben and red dye No. 3. These four additives have been linked to several health problems, including cancer risk and hyperactivity in children.

Initially, titanium dioxide, an ingredient in Skittles, was included in the bill, leading to the belief that the candies would be banned in California.

Although Skittles are safe for now, he noted that there are still as many as 12,000 products, such as Peeps, which contains red dye #3, that could be affected by AB418.

However, just because one ingredient is banned does not mean the entire product is banned. The law will not go into effect until 2027, which gives brands time to change their recipe rather than deciding not to sell their product statewide.

California bans red dye No. 3 and other harmful substances in foods Mustard Skittles: the new flavor that divides opinions

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